

BRAND STYLE GUIDE.

The definitive guide for AEGIS's visual and interaction decisions — palette, typography, logo, tokens, components, layout, and accessibility standards.

Version	Framework	Status	WCAG
3.0	Next.js + React + Tailwind CSS	● Active — Production	2.1 AA

AEGIS IDENTITY

01 — ADVERSARIAL

ADVERSARIAL BY DESIGN

Every interface element is designed to challenge assumptions. Forms validate aggressively. Status indicators are unambiguous. Comfort is not the goal — clarity is.

02 — SURGICAL

SURGICAL PRECISION

No visual fluff. No decoration without purpose. Every rule, every token, every component exists because it solves a specific problem. If it doesn't pull its weight, it's cut.

03 — UNAMBIGUOUS

UNAMBIGUOUS STATE

Users always know exactly what's happening. Loading, success, error, idle — each state is visually distinct and textually explicit. No surprises. No guesswork.

04 — ACCESSIBLE

ACCESSIBLE TO ALL

WCAG 2.1 AA is mandatory, not aspirational. If someone can't use it, it doesn't ship. Accessibility isn't a checklist — it's a non-negotiable design constraint.

01 — COLOUR PALETTE

COLOUR

Every colour in the product maps to a named role. Nothing is applied as a raw hex value in component code.

CORE SURFACES

background

#0F0F0E

Global page background

secondary-surface

#121211

Cards, navbars, panels

tertiary-surface

#30302E

Borders, dividers, hover states

code-editor

#1E2124

Code and editor surfaces

TEXT & BORDER

white-smoke

#F5F5F5

Icon tinting, on-red button labels

default-text

#E6E6DF

Primary body text and headings

default-border

#989892

Input borders, card edges, muted text

ACCENT

system-red

#F4381F

CTAs, active states, focus rings, hover accents

SEMANTIC / STATUS

status-success

#66BB6A

Active / completed / pass

status-success-dim

#388E3C

Success background tints and borders

status-warning

#FFCA28

Pending / in-progress

status-info

#64B5F6

Draft state, informational badges

Rule: use role-based token classes in all component code — `bg-system-red`, never `bg-[#F4381F]`. Background dominates surfaces, secondary-surface structures content, system-red does the work (60/30/10).

Error states currently reuse `system-red` rather than a dedicated error colour, and there is no separate "elevated card" surface distinct from `secondary-surface`. Both are worth introducing as the component library grows, so validation errors and primary actions aren't sharing a single colour.

02 — TYPOGRAPHY

TYPOGRAPHY

Restricted to three font families, each with a distinct functional role.

STAATLICHES

font-staatliches
Headings, buttons, UI chrome

AEGIS ASSESSMENT ARSENAL

IBM PLEX SANS

font-ibm
Body copy, descriptions, form content

Start an assessment with carefully curated adversarial questions designed to evaluate genuine human reasoning.

JETBRAINS MONO

font-jetbrains
Labels, metadata, timestamps, code

ASSESSMENT TITLE * // 2026-07-29 · v3.0 · SYSTEM ONLINE

TYPE SCALE

Element	Font	Size	Class
Page Hero H1	Staatliches	56–96px, responsive	<code>text-4xl lg:text-5xl xl:text-6xl 2xl:text-7xl 3xl:text-8xl</code>
Page Title H2	Staatliches	36px	<code>text-3xl tracking-[.06em]</code>
Panel Title	Staatliches	22px	<code>text-[22px] tracking-[.07em]</code>
Section Header	Staatliches	16px	<code>text-base tracking-[.07em]</code>
Body	IBM Plex Sans	16px	<code>text-base font-ibm leading-relaxed</code>
Body Small	IBM Plex Sans	13px	<code>text-[13px] font-ibm</code>
UI Label	JetBrains Mono	10px	<code>text-[10px] tracking-[.1em]</code>
Caption / Meta	JetBrains Mono	9–10px	<code>text-[10px] text-white-smoke/40</code>
Button Text	Staatliches	13–15px	<code>text-sm tracking-[.05em]</code>

HERO SCALE

Hero headings escalate across five breakpoints rather than sitting at a single fixed size — from `text-4xl` at the base up to `text-8xl` (96px) at the widest `3xl` breakpoint.

INLINE EMPHASIS

To emphasise a single phrase mid-sentence, wrap it in `text-system-red` rather than adding a separate accent line. Use once per block — reserve it for the one phrase that matters most.

LOGO

Primary lockup — AEGIS wordmark with tagline.



Primary lockup • Full colour on dark background

ELEMENT	SPEC
Wordmark	"AEGIS" in Staatliches, uppercase, ~42px on light surfaces, scales proportionally
Tagline	"WHERE AI FIGHTS AI" in JetBrains Mono, uppercase, system-red, smaller weight
Background	Dark backgrounds only — #0F0F0E or #121211

USAGE

- **Clear space:** keep at least the height of the "A" as empty margin on all sides.
- **Minimum size:** don't render below ~120px width — the tagline becomes unreadable.
- **Don't:** recolour the wordmark, stretch or skew the lockup, or place it on light or busy backgrounds.
- **Backgrounds:** designed for **background** / **secondary-surface** dark contexts only.
- **Tagline:** Always paired with the wordmark — never use "AEGIS" alone as a standalone logo.

ICONOGRAPHY

[/public/illustrations/icons/](#) — all SVG, tinted for dark backgrounds.



file-icon.svg
24px — card meta



users-icon.svg
24px — card meta



pie-chart-icon.svg
24px — analytics



clock-icon.svg
24px — timer



search-icon.svg
20px — nav



bell-icon.svg
20px — nav

TINTING

Icon SVGs are tinted to **white-smoke** with a single utility class:

```
.icon-white-smoke {  
  filter: invert(92%) sepia(10%) brightness(100);  
}
```

Third-party exception: OAuth provider icons (Google, and any added later) keep their official brand colours and are never run through **.icon-white-smoke**. They're governed by the provider's own brand guidelines, not ours.

05 — DESIGN TOKENS

TOKENS

Design tokens are named variables that store visual attributes. Each maps to a CSS custom property in **globals.css** — the single source of truth for every colour, font, and shadow value in the product.

SPACING — 8PX GRID

VALUE	SCALE	USE
4px	xs / p-1	Icon gaps, fine adjustments
8px	sm / p-2	Button padding, tight gaps
16px	md / p-4	Standard component padding, card gaps
24px	lg / p-6	Section spacing, panel padding
32px	xl / p-8	Major section breaks
48px	2xl / p-12	Hero spacing, page-level gaps

All spacing is a multiple of 8px — never an arbitrary value like 17px.

BORDER RADIUS

Currently inconsistent across components — the primary Button uses **rounded-md** (6px) while the public Input uses no radius at all. Standardise on one value as the component library matures.

SHADOW

TOKEN	VALUE
shadow-glow-red	0 0 16px rgba(180, 39, 21, 0.6)

SCROLLBAR

PROPERTY	VALUE
Width	8px
Track	secondary-surface
Thumb	white-smoke, fully rounded, 2px inset border
Thumb hover	system-red

TOKEN REFERENCE

TOKEN	HEX	USE
background	#0F0F0E	Global page background
secondary-surface	#121211	Cards, navbars, panels
tertiary-surface	#30302E	Borders, dividers, hover backgrounds
code-editor	#1E2124	Code and editor surfaces
system-red	#F4381F	CTAs, active states, focus rings
white-smoke	#F5F5F5	Icon tinting, on-red labels
default-text	#E6E6DF	Primary text, headings
default-border	#989892	Input borders, card edges
status-success	#66BB6A	Success states, active badges
status-success-dim	#388E3C	Success background tints and borders
status-warning	#FFCA28	Pending, caution states
status-info	#64B5F6	Draft state, informational badges

COMPONENTS

Each component defines its variants, states, and usage constraints.

BUTTONS

LIVE PREVIEW

CONTINUE

SAVE DRAFT

SIGN IN WITH GOOGLE

DISABLED

VARIANT	DEFAULT	HOVER	USE
solid	bg-default-text text-background	bg-transparent border-system-red text-system-red	Primary actions
outline	bg-transparent text-default-text border-default-border	bg-background text-default-text	Secondary actions
social	bg-transparent text-default-text border-default-border	border-system-red	OAuth sign-in

There is currently no dedicated solid-red CTA variant for candidate-facing screens — worth adding a fourth `variant="candidate"` so it doesn't get hand-rolled wherever it's needed.

STATUS BADGES

LIVE PREVIEW

ACTIVE

PENDING

CLOSED

DRAFT

STATUS	BACKGROUND	TEXT
Active	rgba(56,142,60,0.18)	#66BB6A
Pending	rgba(255,202,40,0.12)	#FFCA28
Closed	rgba(51,51,49,0.6)	#989892
Draft	rgba(100,181,246,0.12)	#64B5F6

FORM INPUTS

LIVE PREVIEW

ASSESSMENT TITLE *

e.g. Senior Backend Algorithm Sprint

EMAIL

not-an-email

Invalid email format

Focus state on the public/auth Input is a quiet **default-border** ring — a deliberately calmer treatment than the assertive **system-red** focus ring used on admin-side forms.

07 — LAYOUT

LAYOUT

Layout patterns compose components into full pages.

RESPONSIVE SCALE

Public-facing pages grow across five breakpoints in lockstep — base, **lg**, **xl**, **2xl**, and a custom **3xl**:

```
Container:  max-w-7xl → lg:max-w-6xl → xl:max-w-7xl → 2xl:max-w-full
Padding-x:  px-6 → lg:px-6 → xl:px-8 → 2xl:px-12 → 3xl:px-16
Padding-y:  py-4 → lg:py-5 → xl:py-6 → 2xl:py-7 → 3xl:py-8
Gaps:       gap-4 → lg:gap-5 → xl:gap-6 → 2xl:gap-7 → 3xl:gap-8
```

PAGE TEMPLATES

CANDIDATE LAYOUT

Full-width navbar, generous padding, 4-column card grid on desktop.

ADMIN LAYOUT

220px fixed sidebar, 60px topbar, scrollable main content area.

PHOTOGRAPHY TREATMENT

Hero photography is desaturated to greyscale, leaving **system-red** as the only colour in frame. Keep photos greyscale by default — colour is reserved for the interface, not the imagery.

PANEL SLIDE-OVER

Right-anchored 720px panel over a 60% black overlay. Keeps context visible behind it.

```
[Overlay bg-black/60 z-50]
[Panel w-[720px] right-0]
  [Header + close btn]
  [Stepper]
  [Body - scrollable]
  [Footer - nav btns]
```

LOADING / ERROR / EMPTY

```
Loading: "Loading assessments..."      text-default-text, pt-8
Error:    "{error message}"              text-system-red, pt-8
Empty:    "No assessments assigned yet."  text-default-text, pt-8
```

08 - ACCESSIBILITY - WCAG 2.1 AA

ACCESSIBILITY

Enforced at the component level. All UI must meet WCAG 2.1 AA for contrast, keyboard navigation, and screen reader compatibility.

CONTRAST RATIOS

default-text on background ~15.3:1	system-red on background ~4.96:1	White text on system-red fill ~3.55:1
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AAA ✓ — primary text

AA ✓ — red text / links

⚠ Below 4.5:1 normal-text
threshold

status-success on
background

~6.8:1

AAA ✓

09 - VOICE & TONE

VOICE & TONE

Technical and precise. Not playful, not corporate-friendly, not apologetic.

DO

- Uppercase, verb-first buttons: *Start Assessment*, no periods.
- State problems plainly: *Unable to load assessments*.
- Confirm the action and the outcome: *Assessment deployed successfully*.
- Explain empty states without jargon: *No assessments assigned yet*.

DON'T

- Soften errors with apology language.
- Rely on colour alone to signal status — pair every colour with a text label.
- Mix tone registers within the same screen.

CONTEXT	EXAMPLE	RULE
Navigation labels	Assessments · Candidates · Reports	Uppercase, no trailing punctuation, 1–2 words
Buttons	Start Assessment · Save Draft · Deploy	Verb-first, uppercase, 2–4 words, no periods
Error messages	Unable to load assessments.	Sentence case, states the problem, no apology

CONTEXT	EXAMPLE	RULE
Status indicators	Active · Pending · Closed · Draft	Single word, all-caps, paired with semantic colour
Empty states	No assessments assigned yet.	Sentence case, explains absence, no jargon
Confirmations	Assessment deployed successfully.	Sentence case, past tense, action + outcome

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